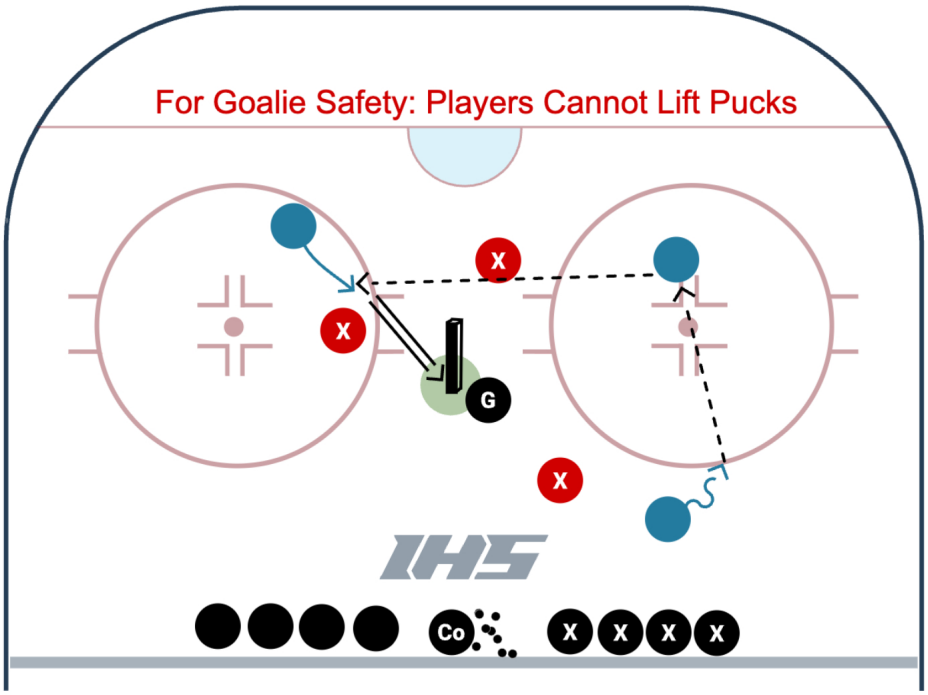
GOALIE DEFEND THE PAD 3V3

Time: **Station:**



Overview

Goalie Defend the Pad 3v3 is a variation of the classic Hit the Tire or small-area 3v3 game. It challenges players to move the puck quickly, support teammates, and finish under pressure, while giving the goalie a chance to track plays and work their edges.

⚠ **Safety Reminder:** Players must keep all shots on the ice. No lifting the puck is allowed when shooting toward the tire, cone, or pad being used.

Setup

- Place a tire, cone, or pad in the middle of the zone. This becomes the target players must hit to score.
- One goalie defends the object as if it were a net.
- On the whistle, a coach rims or dumps a puck into the zone to start 3v3 play.
- The puck-carrying team attacks, while the other group works to regain possession and counterattack.
- If the puck leaves the zone or goes out of play, the coach immediately adds a new puck.
- Games should run in short, competitive bursts of 30–40 seconds.

Coaching Points

- Goalie: Focus on edgework, reading developing plays, and reacting quickly to lateral puck movement.
- Offense: Support the puck carrier, create quick give-and-go opportunities, and shoot quickly before the goalie can set.
- Defense: Keep sticks active, take away passing lanes, and angle opponents to the perimeter.

Variations

- Play without a goalie — teams just aim to hit the object.
- Place two targets (tires, cones, or pads) on the faceoff dots with no goalies.
- Use two targets with a goalie positioned near each one for an added challenge.